

For, During & While

CEFR B1

Lesson Pack · summary, worksheet & answer key

Quick answer

These three all talk about time, but they take different things after them:

- 1 for + a length — for three days, for ten minutes (how long).
- 2 during + a noun — during the meeting, during winter (when).
- 3 while + a clause — while she slept (two actions at once).

Key test: 'during' is followed by a noun; 'while' is followed by a subject + verb. 'For' answers 'how long?'.

At a glance

Word	Followed by	Answers	Example
for	a length of time	how long?	for two hours, for a week
during	a noun (event/period)	when?	during the meeting, during summer
while	a subject + verb (clause)	when? (two actions)	while I was cooking

Learning objectives

- Can use 'for' with a length of time to answer 'how long' (CEFR B1).
- Can use 'during' + noun and 'while' + clause for simultaneous time.
- Can avoid 'during + length of time' errors.

Practice worksheet

Circle the correct option. For, During & While · CEFR B1

Name: _____

Date: _____

1. We waited ____ two hours.

- | | |
|----------|-----------|
| A. for | B. during |
| C. while | D. since |

2. My phone rang ____ the meeting.

- | | |
|-----------|----------|
| A. during | B. for |
| C. while | D. since |

3. ____ I was cooking, the doorbell rang.

- | | |
|----------|-----------|
| A. While | B. During |
| C. For | D. Since |

4. It snowed ____ the night.

- | | |
|-----------|--------|
| A. during | B. for |
| C. while | D. at |

5. She's been studying English ____ five years.

- | | |
|----------|-----------|
| A. for | B. during |
| C. while | D. since |

6. I fell asleep ____ the film.

- | | |
|-----------|--------|
| A. during | B. for |
| C. while | D. by |

7. ____ waiting for the bus, I listened to a podcast.

- | | |
|----------|-----------|
| A. While | B. During |
| C. For | D. Since |

8. Correct this: 'I slept during eight hours.'

- | | |
|--------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| A. I slept for eight hours. | B. I slept while eight hours. |
| C. I slept during eight hours. | D. I slept since eight hours. |

9. Correct this: 'The phone rang while the concert.'

- | | |
|---------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| A. The phone rang during the concert. | B. The phone rang for the concert. |
| C. The phone rang while the concert. | D. The phone rang since the concert. |

10. Which word is followed by a subject + verb?

- | | |
|----------|-----------|
| A. while | B. during |
| C. for | D. at |

Answer key

Correct answers with explanations · for the teacher

1. **A. for** — A length of time takes 'for': 'for two hours'.
2. **A. during** — 'During' + a noun (event): 'during the meeting'.
3. **A. While** — 'While' + a clause: 'While I was cooking'.
4. **A. during** — 'During the night' — a period noun.
5. **A. for** — A length of time takes 'for': 'for five years'.
6. **A. during** — 'During the film' — a period noun.
7. **A. While** — 'While + -ing' (same subject): 'While waiting'.
8. **A. I slept for eight hours.** — A length of time takes 'for': 'for eight hours'.
9. **A. The phone rang during the concert.** — 'During' + a noun: 'during the concert'.
10. **A. while** — 'While' is followed by a clause (subject + verb).